

CCD Board Meeting

- **Date/Time:** Sun, April 12, 2026 · 7:00 PM
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Attendees

- **Board/Participants:** Philip Ogston, Charles Wallner, Larry Langford, Valerie Allendorf, Deven Corzine, Myra Mitchell, Audrey Eyman, Darlene Underwood
- **Absent:** Richard House, Bonnie Carpenter

1. Rental Agreement and Contract Negotiations

Discussion Summary:

The board spent significant time reviewing concerns with the current rental agreement at the Wyoming Fine Arts Center. Several members noted confusion around the most recent version of the contract, prompting Larry Langford to distribute the copy he had. Key issues included the annual renewal requirement, which was viewed as operationally impractical, and the termination clause, which the board felt exposed the organization to unnecessary risk.

There was broad agreement on the importance of securing a longer-term contract to provide stability. Opinions varied on duration: Philip Ogston suggested three years as more realistic, while Darlene Underwood and Audrey Eyman advocated for a five-year term. Charles Wallner cautioned that a five-year contract might be difficult to obtain but supported negotiating for at least three years. Valerie Allendorf emphasized locking in terms for as long as possible to protect Saturday dance slots, which are financially critical.

Financial implications were discussed in detail, including the risk of higher rent and the loss incurred from the most recent Saturday dance. The board also discussed the need for a six-month termination clause and adequate setup and teardown time. Darlene agreed to lead negotiations, supported by Charles and another board member, using a structured negotiation approach ("Dooley method"). The group agreed that educating the Fine Arts Center board on CCD's value and resource needs would be important.

2. Pigtown Review and Discussion

Positional Calling Feedback (Survey and Member Experience)

Discussion Summary:

Feedback from the Pig Town survey revealed that positional calling negatively impacted overall calling ratings for some attendees. Valerie Allendorf shared the survey results, while Philip and Darlene discussed how positional calling can be confusing, particularly during initial exposure. Philip shared a personal example of struggling during his first positional calling dance.

Larry Langford noted that positional calling can help move beyond gender-specific roles and did not personally find it problematic. While opinions varied, the group generally acknowledged that positional calling affects dancer experience differently depending on familiarity. No immediate change was made, but there was consensus that the topic needs continued discussion in future meetings.

Positional Calling and Dance Instruction Practices

Discussion Summary:

Building on earlier feedback, the board discussed positional calling as an instructional tool. Philip highlighted how it can help dancers recover when they lose track of roles, particularly in mixed-role dances. Darlene emphasized its usefulness for aging dancers and explained how positional calling can simplify instructions if applied carefully.

Audrey Eyman noted that positional calling is not a new concept, though it has gained more attention recently. The group agreed that positional calling is one tool among many and does not replace the need for dancers to understand roles fully. Examples were shared from recent events illustrating both benefits and limitations.

Dance Weekend Attendance, Energy, and Scheduling

Discussion Summary:

Valerie Allendorf reported strong attendance and high energy throughout the recent dance weekend, with 363 total attendees. Only one session (Freedom Walls) was negatively affected, largely due to timing. Feedback suggested scheduling lower-energy sessions earlier and starting English country dance earlier in the day.

The Mercer location was generally seen as suitable, though its remoteness created challenges for early start times, especially for attendees staying in Cincinnati. Some attendees delayed feedback because they had no complaints. Catering was mostly well received despite minor criticisms.

Workshops, Venue Usage, and Event Structure

Discussion Summary:

The board discussed workshop attendance and structure. While overall participation was strong,

some workshops were less attended than expected. Charles suggested moving the positional waltz workshop later to increase participation. Survey feedback indicated a preference for fewer workshops and appreciation for topic-specific sessions held in the auditorium.

There were concerns about the event feeling crowded for some attendees, leading to discussion about prioritizing full-weekend registrants. Ideas included using smaller classrooms or music rooms for workshops to add variety and tightening the schedule closer to dinner to improve flow.

Lighting, Sound, and Accessibility Concerns

Discussion Summary:

Darlene raised concerns about dim lighting, noting that older attendees feared falling. Philip and Larry discussed balancing sufficient lighting with maintaining atmosphere. Valerie shared that earplugs were provided at registration and widely used, indicating sound level sensitivity.

Potential solutions discussed included providing personal lighting (e.g., small headlights), while acknowledging the need to be mindful of overall ambiance.

Budget Approval and Planning for 2027

Discussion Summary:

Valerie Allendorf and Myra Mitchell presented the proposed 2027 budget. The plan included a base budget of \$32,850 and a 15% contingency fund of \$4,928 to manage uncertainty. Board members emphasized the importance of early planning and securing future contracts, particularly given ongoing challenges with facility approvals.

3. Final Announcements and Board Transitions

Discussion Summary:

The meeting concluded with reminders about maintaining good relationships with Mercer by using the auditorium appropriately. Audrey Eyman announced her acceptance into graduate school and upcoming move to Chicago, necessitating her early departure from the board. The group congratulated her and acknowledged the need to begin recruiting new board members.

4. Additional Activity from Email Thread

Discussion Additions:

- Via email, the following motion was proposed by Charles, seconded by Myra, and approved by the Board.

Motion 1: In that knowledgeable volunteers to assist in providing quality sound for CCD events, approve the request of Zoey Bryant for \$375.00 match to a her personal contribution of \$230.00 and \$250.00 CDSS grant of at least \$475.00 to receive specific training in sound operations by CDSS.

- The following additional motions can be reviewed at a future Board Meeting:

Motion 2: The CCD Executive Committee be charged to develop policy and procedures to guide CCD Board in approving aide/assistance (based on need of the requestor) to CCD members to further their knowledge in Dane administration. technical skills, dance calling, musicianship, and dancing skills to enhance the mission and programmatic goals of CCD.

Motion 3: The board will determine an annual budget for learning experience by CCD members to further its mission and programmatic goals.

Motion 4: If assistance is granted to further skills to assist CCD programming for year 2026, it will be grandfathered into the line item budget for assistance in training and education to further CCD mission and goal.

Key Decisions

- Approved a **base 2027 budget of \$32,850** with a **15% contingency fund (\$4,928)**.
- Agreed to **pursue a multi-year rental contract**, targeting three years minimum, with negotiation for longer term if possible.
- Agreed to **continue evaluating positional calling**, with no immediate policy change.

Key Action Items

- **Darlene Underwood** to initiate contact with Brianna and lead rental contract negotiations, with support from Charles and another board member.
- Negotiation team to address termination clause, contract length, setup/teardown time, and rent stability.
- Add **future agenda items** to continue discussion on positional calling impacts.
- Incorporate **attendee feedback** into future event scheduling, workshop structure, lighting, and accessibility planning.
- Begin **recruitment for new board members** to replace departing members.

